

Chinese in Wales Association: About Us

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Corpus role: Community (CIWA) — national-origin index

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Chinese in Wales Association (CIWA), headquartered in Swansea, Wales. Source: chineseinwales.org.uk/about-us. Community-partner material, used as LPA corpus ground-truth with partner consent.

About the organisation

The Chinese in Wales Association (CIWA) is a charitable organisation that aims to make a positive difference to the lives of ethnic Chinese residents in Wales. It was set up to meet the changing demographic needs of the Chinese community in Wales, building on the support given by the Swansea Chinese Community Co-op Centre over the previous 20 years, and aims to extend its services and community-building to other parts of Wales. CIWA operates a drop-in community centre at the Swansea Grand Theatre, providing core services including language support in Mandarin, Cantonese and English, alongside advocacy, information services and case referral, with advice on local welfare, housing, healthcare, education and employment.

Aims

CIWA aims to make a positive difference to the lives of ethnic Chinese residents in Wales through:

- promoting community cohesion, both within the ethnic Chinese community and the wider community;
- delivering to and representing the Chinese community, including disabled people, children, young people and elderly people, with planning and service delivery to ensure their complete wellbeing;
- supporting members of the ethnic Chinese community facing disadvantage to address the inequalities they face and enabling them to participate fully in society;
- promoting both Chinese and Welsh culture and heritage to explore and advance cultural exchange between the two communities;
- progressing any other activities that promote the health, wellbeing, welfare, art and culture of ethnic Chinese residents in Wales;
- having due regard to the provisions of the Equality Act.

Vision

CIWA is committed to being one of the leading national charities providing excellent community services across Wales.

Community history and background

CIWA notes that the mainstream view of the Chinese community as homogeneous — a single group of migrants from China — is mistaken: the community spans diverse south-east Asian backgrounds, varied education levels, and many British-born and Welsh-born Chinese. Chinese migration to Wales has a history of at least 100 years, with the largest influxes from the 1940s to the 1970s, mainly from Hong Kong and Guangdong; a large proportion of Chinese Britons today are second- or third-generation. Since 2000, increasing numbers of students and highly skilled migrants have come from mainland China, and Mandarin has replaced Cantonese as the dominant language within the community. Early-year immigrants are ageing while newer immigrants are settling and growing, producing a complex set of needs driven by demographic transition.

Key statistics (2011 Census and later data)

- There were 13,638 people of Chinese origin in Wales, with concentrations in Cardiff (4,168) and Swansea (2,052); ethnic Chinese people are the third-largest ethnic minority group in Wales.
- Ethnic Chinese people are the largest non-white ethnic group in Swansea (0.9% of the population).
- Language and English proficiency: 39% of Mandarin speakers, 40% of Cantonese speakers, and 30% of other Chinese-language speakers have little or no English-speaking skills.
- In Q2 2016, the largest group of asylum seekers receiving section-95 support in Wales were nationals of China (364 people), mainly in Cardiff, Swansea, Newport and Wrexham.

How this anchors the LPA corpus

This card defines the **community context** of the second partner and grounds the **national-origin typology index** (and the national-origin dimension of race-based hostility). Several features are directly relevant to moderation design: CIWA's explicit rejection of the "homogeneous migrant" framing speaks to the kind of reductive, nationality-framed narratives the national-origin typology targets; the **language-proficiency data** signals that a meaningful proportion of community members operate primarily in Mandarin or Cantonese, with implications for how content is read and for accessibility of any community-facing tooling; and the **asylum and migration** dimension connects to the economically- and immigration-framed hostility that public datasets capture poorly. It pairs with CIWA's Projects card and complements RCC's materials on the race/ethnicity side.